

**PRAYER JOURNAL WEEK #2**

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## 1st Prayer

The prayer speaks of a simple lesson. Simple lessons are very good, but in my opinion, complicated lessons are good if it is built on simplicity. There really is no hard and fast rule about anything. As the Bible says, where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is freedom; and we are free from the law.

The next thing it talks about is that we know so little of the love of the Father. Now, I understand we can never understand the great depths and lengths to the degree that Jesus does, but I do know a great depth of God's love. But yes, I want to know more. When I wallow in my sin and have difficulty in life, if I were to know God's love at that time, I may be happier and healed. As the prayer says, his love is "nearer, clearer, dearer" to us.

The text says, God's love is pitying. This is a great assurance because if we have to earn his love through merit, that would be very difficult. Instead, we earn it through our sorrow and repentance - where earn may not exactly be the best word.

## Prayer 2

The prayer starts with sending the Son. The sending of the Son was the most important event in history. Although there have been many major events in history, like the creation of the atom bomb, the Son changed everything. And the greatest gift is the Holy Spirit. Without the Holy Spirit, we can see God and know the text, but we cannot make it our own. The Holy Spirit guides us into the truth and heals us. The prayer says that everyone who asks receives. This is a tough proposition because not everything is actually received. We need to understand we ask for things that are bad for us at times, and God gives us what we really need and truly desire.

### Prayer 3

The prayer says the teaching is glorious. This is true. The glory of the wisdom and truth of God is found in the Bible. I have to say, there is a lot to wisdom, which includes modern science. And all science and even Asian philosophy is part of Jesus' teaching, which are glorious. It says that the power of persevering prayer is something he wants to know more. This is a beautiful thing because often we are tired and sidetracked by many things. We need to persevere in prayer and focus on God more than man or with the world.

The growth and ripeness that comes with knowing Christ is a beautiful thing and we find that everyday we are getting closer to God by going from glory to glory and increasing in holiness. But it is a good question whether we can go backward in faith - because David lost so much by having fornication with Bathsheba. But I think in general, we all increase in holiness and if something bad happens in our walk with God, it is considered more of a purification than a step backward.

### Prayer 4

The prayer says the Lord is blessed. This is a good truth because the Bible in the Old Testament and New say that the Lord is blessed. What this means is that the Lord has every good attribute and character and nature. Because the Lord is good and holy, he is blessed. In this life, the good and holy are blessed. This means that if you are poor in spirit and contrite in heart, and mourning you will be truly blessed. The riches of this world, and the prayers of the heartless are not blessed.

Spiritual realities are things that people often pass by. They look at the things you can see - not at the things unseen. Thus, people are often sidetracked into thinking that working and money and relationships are all there are in life. We need to understand there is a spiritual war in

our lives and that without the understanding of spiritual realities, we may fall into many snares and suffer and die.

#### Prayer 5

Having no doubt is a blessing. It is called assurance. It is certainty. It is confidence. Without it, we have doubt. Doubt causes us to think that something bad may happen - it originates in fear and uncertainty. Our psychology shows that when we are comfortable, we have freedom and free will - but when we are stressed, we often think linearly and in a narrow way. God wants us to be free - where the Spirit of the Lord is there is freedom. Freedom is also called liberty. Lord help us to pray effectually!